



DRAFT FOR REVIEW

Safe Work Method Statements

Commonwealth Avenue Bridge — Pigeon (Feral Rock Dove) Management & Removal

Ecological works within the bridge structure · Parkes, ACT

Document number	EC-SWMS-CAB-2026	Revision	0 — Draft for review
Prepared by	Ecology Consulting — WHS / Field team	Document release date	
Approved by	Tony Webster (WHS Officer) · Lesley Peden (Managing Director)	Document revision date	

Note: Work must be performed in accordance with this Safe Work Method Statement (SWMS). This SWMS must be kept and available for inspection until the high risk construction work is completed. If revised, every version must be kept. If a notifiable incident occurs in relation to the high risk work in this SWMS, the SWMS must be kept for at least 2 years from the date of the notifiable incident. This is a DRAFT prepared for client and internal review; assumptions are noted in the scope statement of each SWMS and should be confirmed prior to finalisation.

Project & PCBU details

Person conducting a business or undertaking (PCBU)	Ecology Consulting Pty Ltd · ABN 68 647 633 163	Contact number	0474 569 988 (EC office)
EC offices	34 Atchison St, Wollongong NSW 2500 · 42 Goulburn St, Crookwell NSW 2583 · 473 Townsend St, Albury NSW 2640		
Client / Principal Contractor	Seymour Whyte Constructions — Hugh Gallagher , Senior Project Engineer · Flynn Dr, Parkes ACT 2600 · hugh.gallagher@seymourwhyte.com.au · +61 438 360 817		
Work activity	Ecological management of feral pigeons (Rock Dove, <i>Columba livia</i>) within the Commonwealth Avenue Bridge structure — inspection, capture / removal, exclusion (proofing), and guano / nest material clearance from internal voids and box-girder cells; screening for protected native fauna (e.g. microbats) prior to and during works, in accordance with EC Standard Operating Procedures.		
Workplace location	Commonwealth Avenue Bridge, over Lake Burley Griffin, Parkes / Acton, ACT 2600 (National Land)		
Field work duration	To be confirmed with Principal Contractor		

Relevant legislation, codes of practice, protocols & Australian Standards

Acts & Regulations	Work Health and Safety Act 2011 (Cth) & WHS Regulations 2011 (Cth) — Comcare jurisdiction on National Land; Work Health and Safety Act 2011 (ACT) & WHS Regulation 2011 (ACT); Work Health and Safety Act 2011 (NSW) & WHS Regulation 2017 (NSW) — where NSW-based personnel / requirements apply.
Codes of Practice	Safe Work Australia model Codes (as adopted in ACT & NSW): <i>Confined spaces</i> ; <i>Managing the risk of falls at workplaces</i> ; <i>Managing risks of plant in the workplace</i> ; <i>Construction work</i> ; <i>How to manage work health and safety risks</i> ; <i>First aid in the workplace</i> ; <i>Managing the work environment and facilities</i> ; <i>Preparation of SWMS for high risk construction work</i> . NSW Codes of Practice as adopted.
Australian Standards	AS 2865 Confined spaces; AS/NZS 1891 Industrial fall-arrest systems & devices; AS/NZS 1715 & 1716 Selection, use & maintenance of respiratory protective equipment; AS/NZS 1801 Occupational protective helmets; AS 1319 Safety signs for the occupational environment.
Health / biological	enHealth / SafeWork guidance on psittacosis (<i>Chlamydia psittaci</i>) and histoplasmosis from bird droppings; work with contaminated dust / guano.
Environmental / animal welfare & EC protocols	Environment Protection and Biodiversity Conservation Act 1999 (Cth); Nature Conservation Act 2014 (ACT); Biodiversity Conservation Act 2016 (NSW); Animal Welfare Act 1992 (ACT). Ecology Consulting <i>Terrestrial Fauna Survey — Standard Operating Procedures</i> (Nov 2025); EC Field Plan, Site-Specific Emergency Response Plan (ERP) and EC Check-in protocol.

High risk construction work applicable to this project

Categories under WHS Regulation. ✓ = applicable to these works and covered by a SWMS in this set.

✓	Work in or near a confined space (bridge voids / box-girder cells)	✓	Work in an area with movement of powered mobile plant
✓	Risk of a person falling more than 2 metres	✓	Work on, in or adjacent to a road / traffic corridor in use by traffic
✓	Work in or near water (Lake Burley Griffin) — risk of drowning	✓	Work on or near energised electrical installations or services (if present in structure)
✓	Work in an area that may have a contaminated or flammable atmosphere (confined voids)	—	Explosives · tilt-up/precast · telecommunications tower · pressurised gas mains · diving · tunnel boring — <i>not applicable</i>

Additional critical hazard (not a listed HRCW category): Biological / zoonotic exposure from accumulated pigeon guano, feathers and nest material — including psittacosis and histoplasmosis — is a primary hazard for these works and is controlled under SWMS C.

Mandatory PPE & site equipment (all works)

Baseline PPE for all personnel; task-specific additions are listed in each SWMS. RPE is mandatory for any exposure to guano / dust.

Hard Hat	P2/P3 Respirator	Safety Glasses	Nitrile + Work Gloves	Hearing Protection	Hi-Vis Clothing	Disposable Coveralls	Sun Safe PPE	Capped Boots
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☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Gas Detector	Fall-arrest Harness	Fire Extinguisher	Remote First Aid Kit	In-Reach / Sat Phone	Two-Way Radio	Torch / Headlight	Buoyancy Aid (PFD)	Floating Rescue Rope
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Hierarchy of controls

Eliminate	Avoid entry to bridge voids where practicable — inspect from access hatches using cameras / borescopes; capture / exclude from outside the void where possible.
Substitute	Use lower-risk methods — remote observation, one-way exclusion devices, and dust-suppressed (wet) guano removal instead of dry disturbance.
Isolate	Establish exclusion zones; work within Principal Contractor traffic management / lane closures; isolate services and plant; separate personnel from the water edge and drop-offs.
Engineer	Use provided fixed access, walkways, edge protection, ventilation and lighting; mechanical ventilation of voids; harness / fall-arrest anchorage where authorised.
Administrative	SWMS, confined space entry permits, atmospheric testing, standby person, minimum two-person teams, EC Check-in, toolbox talks, communication protocol, stop-work triggers, EC SOPs and animal-welfare procedures.
PPE	Last line of defence — P2/P3 RPE, disposable coveralls, gloves, eye protection, helmet, capped boots, hi-vis, PFD near water, fall-arrest harness where required.

Staff details & workers consulted in the development of this SWMS

Name	Company role	Project / SWMS role	Signature / date
Lesley Peden	Managing Director — 0400 806 089	Project Lead	
Tony Webster	WHS Officer — 0448 439 334	WHS review / approval	
Grace Stephenson	Project Manager — 0474 569 988	EC Check-in Officer	
	Principal Ecologist	Field Lead	
	Ecologist / Field Assistant	EC Communication Officer	

Other key EC contacts and check-in details: please contact the EC office on 0474 569 988. Field Lead, roles and workers to be confirmed onsite and recorded on the Daily Toolbox Talk WHS form.

SWMS 00 · Planning, preparation & travelling to site

Applies to all works. Pre-mobilisation, daily toolbox talk, EC Check-in and documentation requirements.

Scope & assumption: Ecology Consulting attends as a specialist ecological subcontractor to Seymour Whyte (Principal Contractor). The PC retains responsibility for site control, access, traffic management, confined space permit systems, isolation of plant/services and emergency arrangements. EC works are limited to ecological inspection, fauna management/removal and associated guano/nest clearance; EC personnel will not undertake construction, structural or plant activities.

What are the hazards & risks	What are the control measures	Select relevant controls (to be completed onsite by Field Lead)
Pre-mobilisation		
Inadequate planning leading to incident / injury; unsafe travel or site access	Review Field Plan, Site-Specific Emergency Response Plan (ERP) and all relevant SWMS, SOPs and JSAs prior to mobilisation. Complete en-route and site communication coverage checks, traffic and weather checks. Complete equipment, device and PPE checks (present, functional, fit for purpose). Drivers complete the approved Pre-Travel Vehicle Checklist. All personnel complete a fatigue self-assessment. Communication Officer completes a comms check-in and confirms coverage before departure.	☐ Field Plan & ERP reviewed ☐ SWMS/SOP/JSA reviewed ☐ Vehicle checklist done ☐ Fatigue self-assessment ☐ Comms confirmed
Conditions become unsafe en route or on site	Cease-work / stop-travel protocol: if conditions become unsafe (weather deterioration, poor visibility, fatigue, road hazards, loss of communication) STOP work or travel immediately and notify the Communication Officer without delay.	☐ Protocol briefed
Arrival on site & daily controls		
Lack of understanding of site risks; incomplete documentation; unauthorised access	Report to PC site office; complete PC site induction and sign-in. Field Lead conducts a pre-commencement Daily Toolbox Talk covering the day's activities, risks/hazards and controls (tick relevant hazards in the risk assessment). All personnel sign the Daily Toolbox Talk WHS form before commencing — no worker starts without sign-off. Field Lead ensures all workers complete EC Check-in via the EC Check-in Officer within required time parameters. All site-specific documentation completed and submitted prior to fieldwork.	☐ PC induction complete ☐ Toolbox talk & sign-off ☐ Risk assessment ticked ☐ EC Check-in complete
Unclear roles leading to miscommunication / injury	Field Lead assigns onsite roles: Field Lead (overall control), Communication Officer (comms check-ins, reports to EC office every 1–2 hrs), and workers. Confirm PC Site Supervisor and key contact. Establish and test the communication protocol with the PC and (where relevant) traffic controllers before commencing.	☐ Roles assigned ☐ PC contact confirmed ☐ Comms tested

SWMS A · Work in or near a confined space

Bridge internal voids / box-girder cells, access chambers and enclosed cavities · High risk construction work.

Scope & assumption: Internal cells of the bridge structure are to be treated as confined spaces until proven otherwise. EC personnel will **not** enter a confined space unless a confined space entry permit system is implemented and authorised by the Principal Contractor, and EC personnel entering hold current confined space entry competency. Where entry is not permitted, works are limited to inspection from access points using cameras / borescopes and external exclusion methods.

What are the hazards & risks	What are the control measures	Select relevant controls (to be completed onsite by Field Lead)
Determination, permits & competency		
Unauthorised or uncontrolled entry into a confined space	Field Lead determines whether the space is a confined space (not designed for continuous occupancy; limited entry/exit; may contain hazardous atmosphere, contaminants or engulfment risk). Bridge voids, box-girder cells and underpass cavities are treated as confined spaces. A valid PC-issued Confined Space Entry Permit (location, authorised personnel, duration, hazards & controls, atmospheric results, sign-in/out) must be in place before any entry. No entry without a current permit.	☐ Space classified ☐ CS entry permit valid ☐ Sign-in/out log
Lack of training / competency	Personnel entering hold current confined space entry training (RIIWHWS202E <i>Enter and work in confined spaces</i> or equivalent) and are trained in hazard identification, gas monitor use and emergency procedures. Training records verified before site attendance. No confined space work unless competency is held.	☐ RIIWHWS202E verified ☐ Records held
Atmosphere & ventilation		
Oxygen deficiency/enrichment; toxic gases; flammable atmosphere; airborne guano dust	Atmospheric testing by a competent person with calibrated gas detection, from outside the space where possible: O ₂ 19.5–23.5%, flammable gas <5% LEL, toxic gases (CO, H ₂ S). Continuous monitoring during entry. Provide/confirm ventilation (natural or mechanical) to maintain safe atmosphere. Work ceases immediately if O ₂ out of range, gas limits exceeded, or alarm triggers.	☐ Pre-entry test ☐ Continuous monitoring ☐ Ventilation confirmed
Standby, communication & rescue		
Loss of contact; entrapment; delayed rescue; lone-worker risk	Dedicated standby person positioned outside the space at all times — maintains continuous comms, monitors conditions, has immediate access to rescue/first-aid equipment, performs no other task and does not enter. Minimum two-person team. Continuous comms via voice/radio/hand signals with regular check-ins. Site-specific rescue plan based on non-entry rescue ; rescue conducted by PC / emergency services only — EC staff must not attempt confined space rescue. Entry/exit tracking (permit log / tag-in-out) so no person is unaccounted for.	☐ Standby person set ☐ 2-person minimum ☐ Rescue plan (non-entry) ☐ Entry/exit tracking
Isolation, biological & water hazards		
Uncontrolled energy / plant; biological exposure (guano); water inflow / flooding	Confirm isolation (LOTO) of mechanical/electrical systems, adjacent plant, and any water inflow/discharge before entry; where isolation is not possible minimise risk by other controls. Biological hazards from guano/contaminated surfaces controlled per SWMS C (RPE, coveralls, gloves, hygiene). Assess upstream weather / water levels; do not enter cells subject to flooding during or after rainfall; monitor continuously.	☐ Isolation verified ☐ SWMS C applied ☐ Water risk assessed

SWMS B · Risk of a person falling more than 2 metres

Work at height on/under the bridge — access platforms, edges, hatches, elevated survey points (note: 3 m in some jurisdictions).

Scope & assumption: Access to the underside / internal structure is provided and controlled by the Principal Contractor (e.g. underbridge platform, EWP, fixed walkways or scaffold with edge protection). EC personnel work from provided access only and do not erect or modify access equipment. Fall-arrest is used only where an authorised, engineer-rated anchorage and a trained operator are available.

What are the hazards & risks	What are the control measures	Select relevant controls (to be completed onsite by Field Lead)
Fall from edge, hatch, platform or into the void / water below	Eliminate where possible — inspect from safe ground / fixed platforms using cameras, borescopes or extended equipment. Use provided edge protection, guardrails, defined walkways and covered/secured hatches. Do not lean over or overreach edges; maintain safe setback distance. Where fall risk remains, use a compliant fall-arrest system (AS/NZS 1891) on an authorised anchorage, fitted and used by trained personnel; inspect harness/lanyard before use.	☐ Access from safe ground ☐ Edge protection in place ☐ Hatches secured ☐ Harness inspected (if used)
Slips, trips and falls on uneven, wet or unstable surfaces; poor visibility	Plan safe access routes; maintain three points of contact when climbing. Wear capped boots with good tread. Carry equipment in backpacks to keep hands free; limit load weight. Ensure adequate lighting (head torch + backup); do not work near fall hazards in poor visibility. Move slowly and deliberately; test ground/edge stability before committing weight.	☐ Route planned ☐ Footwear checked ☐ Lighting adequate
Falling objects / tools striking persons below	Hard hats worn. Tools tethered where working above others or water. Establish exclusion below the work area with the PC. Do not stand under unsupported structures or active overhead work.	☐ Tools tethered ☐ Exclusion below set
Fatigue / prolonged work near fall hazards	Schedule regular breaks; monitor team fatigue; rotate tasks; cease work if fatigue affects safety.	☐ Breaks scheduled

SWMS C · Biological & zoonotic hazards — guano, bird handling & removal

Feral pigeon (Rock Dove) management, capture / removal, exclusion and guano / nest clearance. Primary hazard for these works.

Scope & assumption: Feral pigeons are an introduced species and not protected; however native fauna (e.g. microbats, other birds) may occupy the same voids and **are protected** under EPBC Act 1999 (Cth) and Nature Conservation Act 2014 (ACT). All work is undertaken in accordance with the EC *Terrestrial Fauna Survey SOP* and animal-welfare requirements. If protected fauna are detected, pause works affecting them and refer to the Principal Ecologist / relevant approvals before proceeding.

What are the hazards & risks	What are the control measures	Select relevant controls (to be completed onsite by Field Lead)
Inhalation / zoonotic disease		
Psittacosis (<i>Chlamydia psittaci</i>) & histoplasmosis from inhaling aerosolised guano / dust; cryptococcosis; airborne feathers	No dry sweeping or dry disturbance of guano. Dampen / wet down guano and nest material before removal to suppress dust. Mandatory P2 minimum (P3 preferred) respiratory protection fit-tested per AS/NZS 1715/1716, plus disposable coveralls, gloves and eye protection for all guano-disturbing tasks. Provide ventilation in enclosed areas. No eating, drinking or smoking in the work area. There is no vaccine for psittacosis — RPE and dust suppression are the primary controls. Personnel who develop flu-like symptoms after works must seek medical advice and advise their GP of bird/guano exposure.	☐ Wet-down applied ☐ P2/P3 RPE fit-checked ☐ Coveralls + gloves ☐ No eat/drink zone ☐ Health advice briefed
Contact / contamination		
Skin/eye contact with guano, contaminated water/surfaces; ectoparasites (bird mites, ticks, fleas); <i>Salmonella</i>; needlestick/sharps in accumulated debris	Cover skin (long sleeves/coveralls, gloves). Treat all standing water and surfaces as contaminated. Apply insect repellent where mites/ticks are a risk; inspect for and remove ectoparasites after works. Do not handle sharps by hand. Strict hand hygiene — wash before breaks and after removing PPE. Cover any cuts/abrasions with waterproof dressings before entry.	☐ Skin covered ☐ Repellent applied ☐ Cuts covered ☐ Hand hygiene
Bird capture, removal & exclusion (animal welfare)		
Bites/scratches; distress to animals; capture of non-target / protected fauna; inhumane outcomes	Only trained EC personnel capture/handle fauna, following the EC Terrestrial Fauna SOP and animal-welfare requirements — minimise handling, restrain calmly, minimise time held. Use appropriate capture equipment (nets, hand-nets) and gloves. Confirm target species before removal; check for and avoid non-target / protected fauna (e.g. microbats roosting in voids) — if present, cease and refer to Principal Ecologist. Exclusion (proofing / one-way devices / netting) installed so no bird is trapped inside; inspect for and remove active native nests only under the relevant approval. Any euthanasia only by approved humane method under authorisation.	☐ Trained handler ☐ SOP followed ☐ Non-target check ☐ Exclusion verified
Decontamination & waste		
Secondary / offsite contamination; improper waste disposal	Remove PPE in a controlled manner at end of task; do not shake or blow down clothing. Double-bag guano/nest waste and disposable PPE; label and dispose per site waste procedures. Clean/decontaminate boots and reusable equipment before leaving. Bag and launder or dispose of coveralls; wash hands and exposed skin thoroughly.	☐ PPE removed safely ☐ Waste double-bagged ☐ Equipment decon